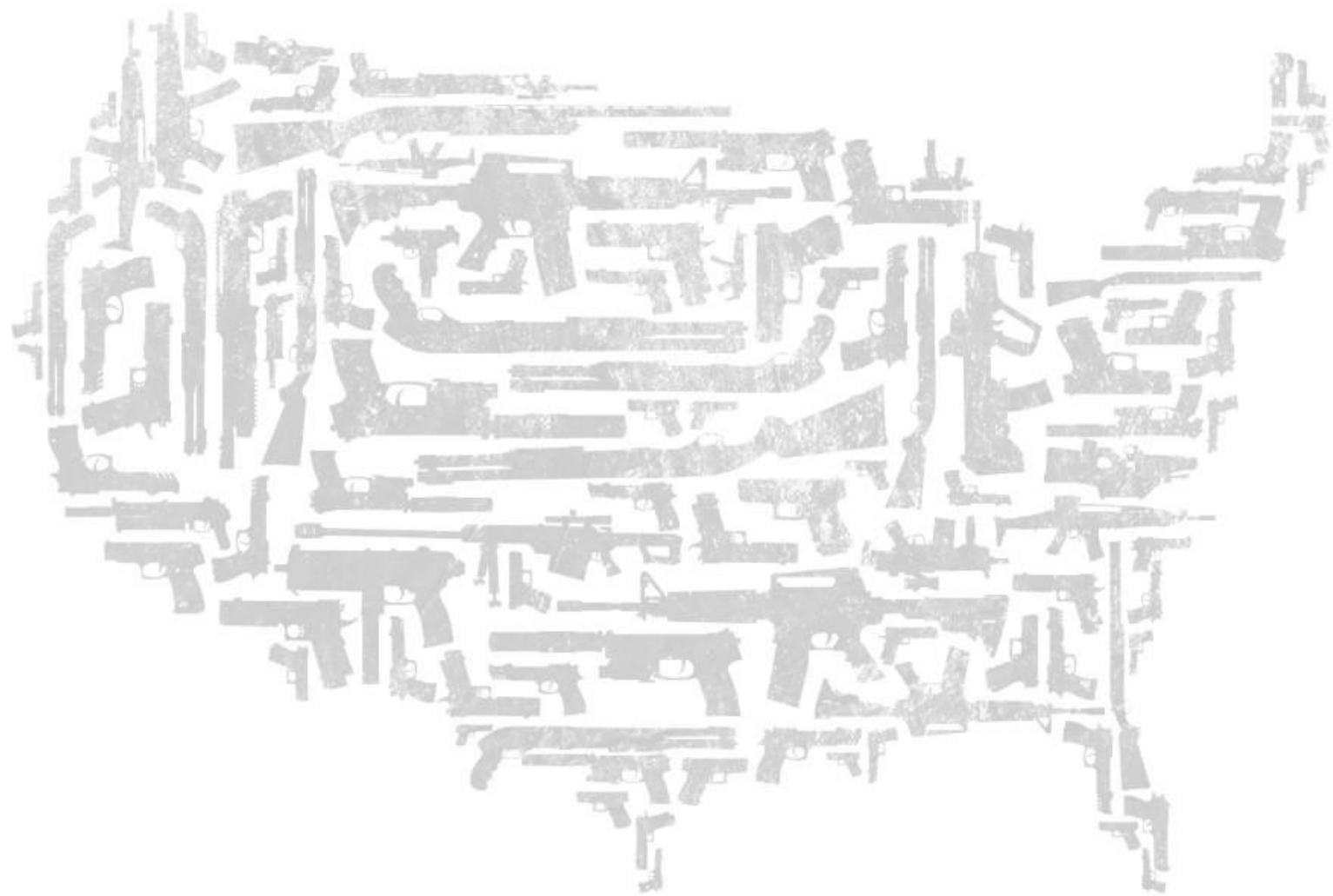


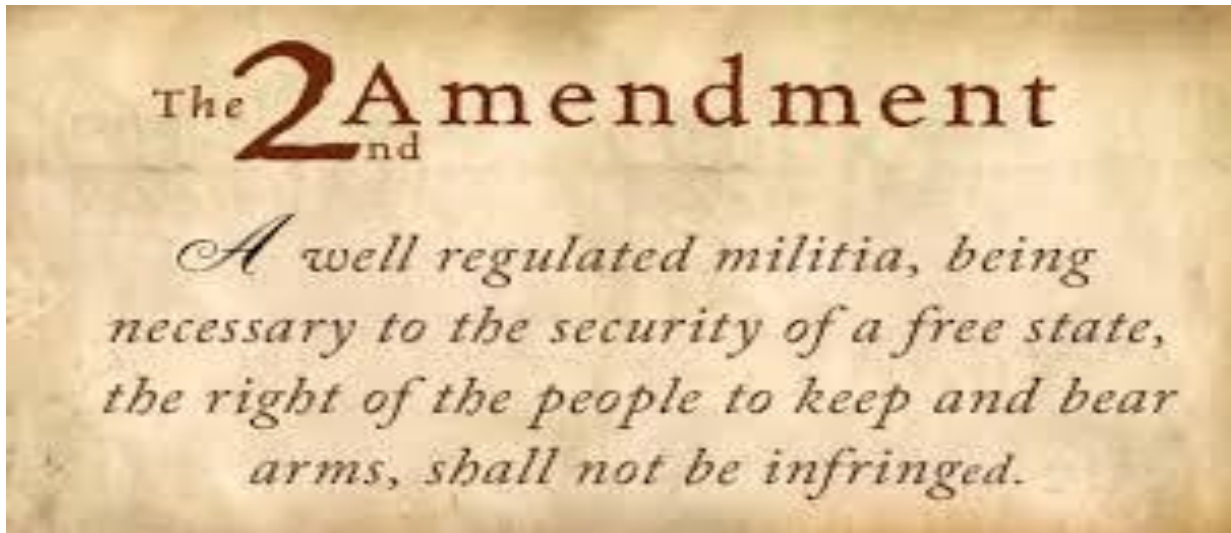


WHY IS GUN CULTURE SO DEEPLY ENTRENCHED IN THE US?

Roots of gun culture

1. THE LAW

The Second Amendment to the Constitution (1791), which is part of the Bill of Rights (1689) reads :



Constitutional reasons : it's nearly impossible to make a change to the 2nd amendment (3/4 states required to change an amendment or a 2/3 majority in the House and the Senate)

2. HISTORY

Guns were used against Native Americans, during the Conquest of the West and to get free from the English.

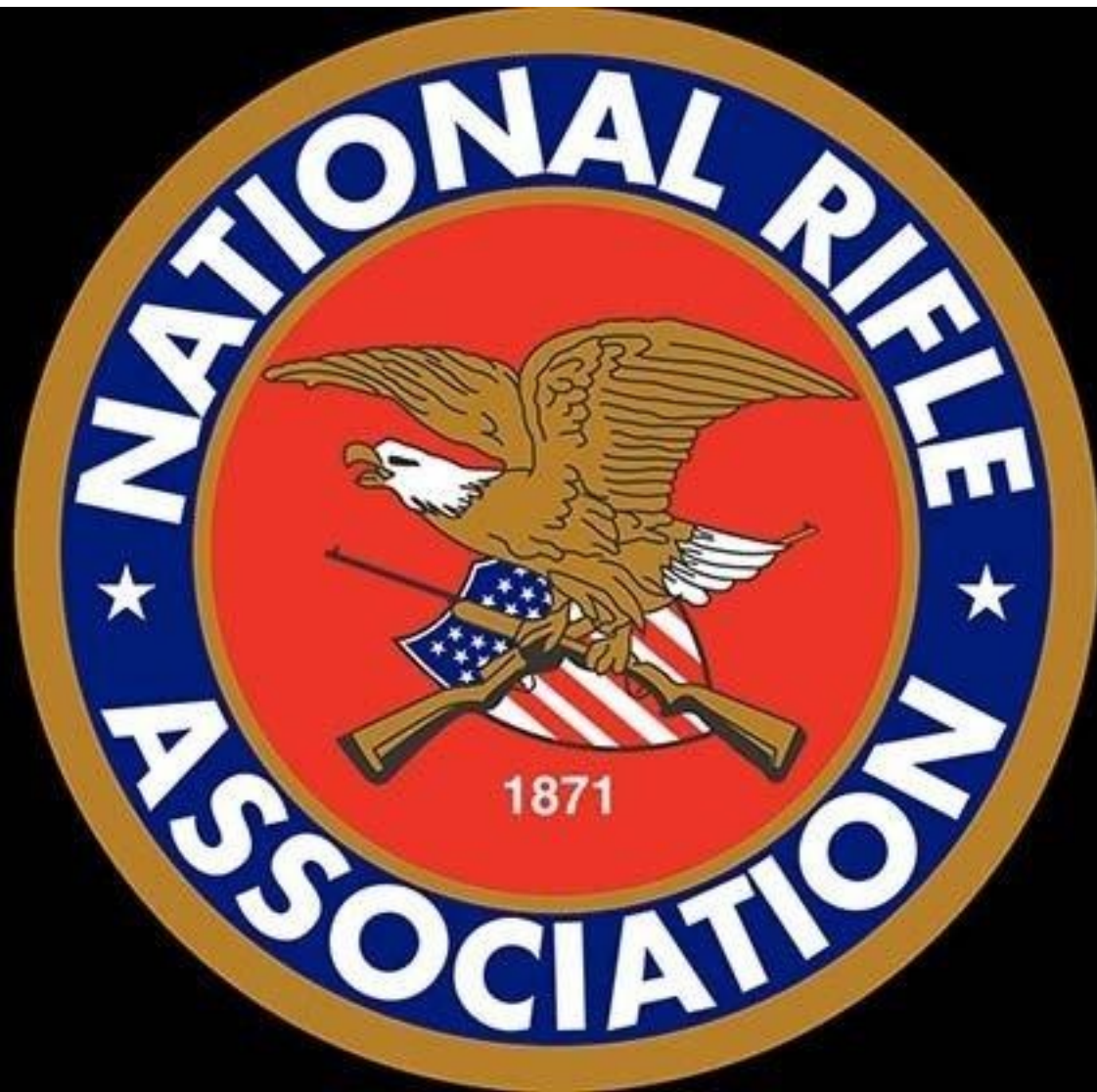
Guns are inseparable from the American identity and mythology.

3. IDEOLOGICAL REASONS

- Ideology of **self-reliance** : everybody should take their fate and their life in their own hands rather than counting on the government.
- Ideology of **self -defence** : citizens have **the right to defend themselves, their families and their properties** -> 72% people own guns for this reason (in Pew Research Center, 2024)

4. POLITICAL AND ECONOMIC REASONS

- the gun industry weighs heavily on the economy: in 2023, it contributed more than \$90 billion to the U.S. economy
- the **NRA** is one of the biggest **contributors to political campaigns** in the country



Created in 1871

Powerful and conservative pro-gun
lobby

Claimed membership: 5m

AN EARLY ACCESS TO GUNS

According to the federal law the minimum age for gun ownership is:

- * 18 to purchase shotguns and rifles,
- * 21 to purchase all other firearms.



AN EASY ACCESS TO GUNS

Guns can be bought **almost everywhere**

- **in gun shops** : background checks are not very efficient
- **in gun shows or gun fairs** : they are open to everybody = family event
- **in supermarkets** and other shops where guns are sold **over the counter**
- **on the black market**

The average cost of a handgun is **between \$400 and \$1,500**



OWN THE SCHOOL YEAR LIKE A HERO



State Law requires that:

- To purchase a handgun, you must be 21 years of age or older.
- To purchase a rifle or shotgun, you must be 18 years of age or older.

Federal Law requires that:

- You must be 21 years of age or older to purchase handgun ammunition.
- You must be 18 years of age or older to purchase shotguns, rifles, or ammunition for shotguns or rifles.
- You must provide valid government issued identification, including photo, name, date of birth, and place of residence. A current valid driver's license is preferred.

Federal Law

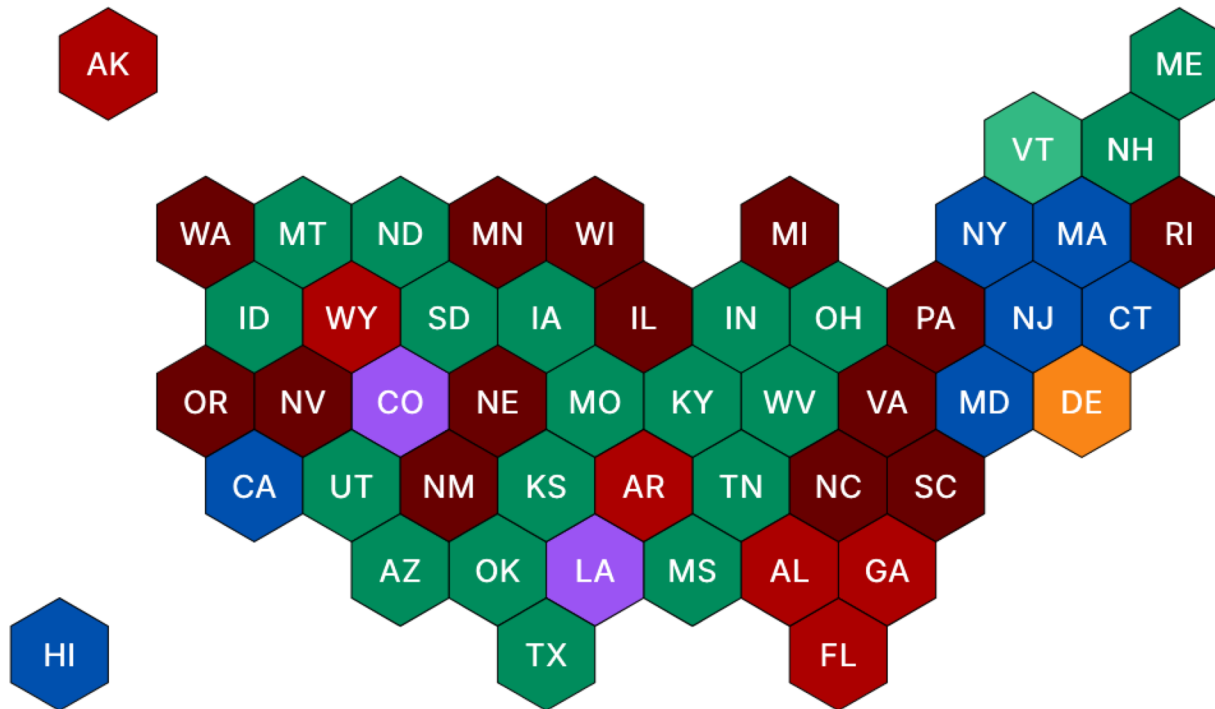
requires



“SHALL-ISSUE” VS “MAY-ISSUE” STATES

Shall-Issue: Local authorities are required to issue concealed carry permits as long as the applicant meets basic requirements such as a minimum age, no prior felony conviction, and no recent commitments to a mental institution. State laws vary on whether the permit applicant needs to be a resident.

May-Issue: Citizens may be granted concealed carry permits at the discretion of local authorities, who may deny permits. Individual state requirements vary but may include residency, passing a training course, and passing a criminal background check.



Shall Issue

- Constitutional Carry and Does Not Issue Permits
- Constitutional Carry and Shall Issue to Residents and Non-Residents
- Constitutional Carry and Shall Issue to Residents Only
- May Issue to Residents and Non-Residents
- May Issue to Residents Only
- Shall Issue to Residents and Non-Residents
- Shall Issue to Residents Only

STAND-YOUR-GROUND LAW

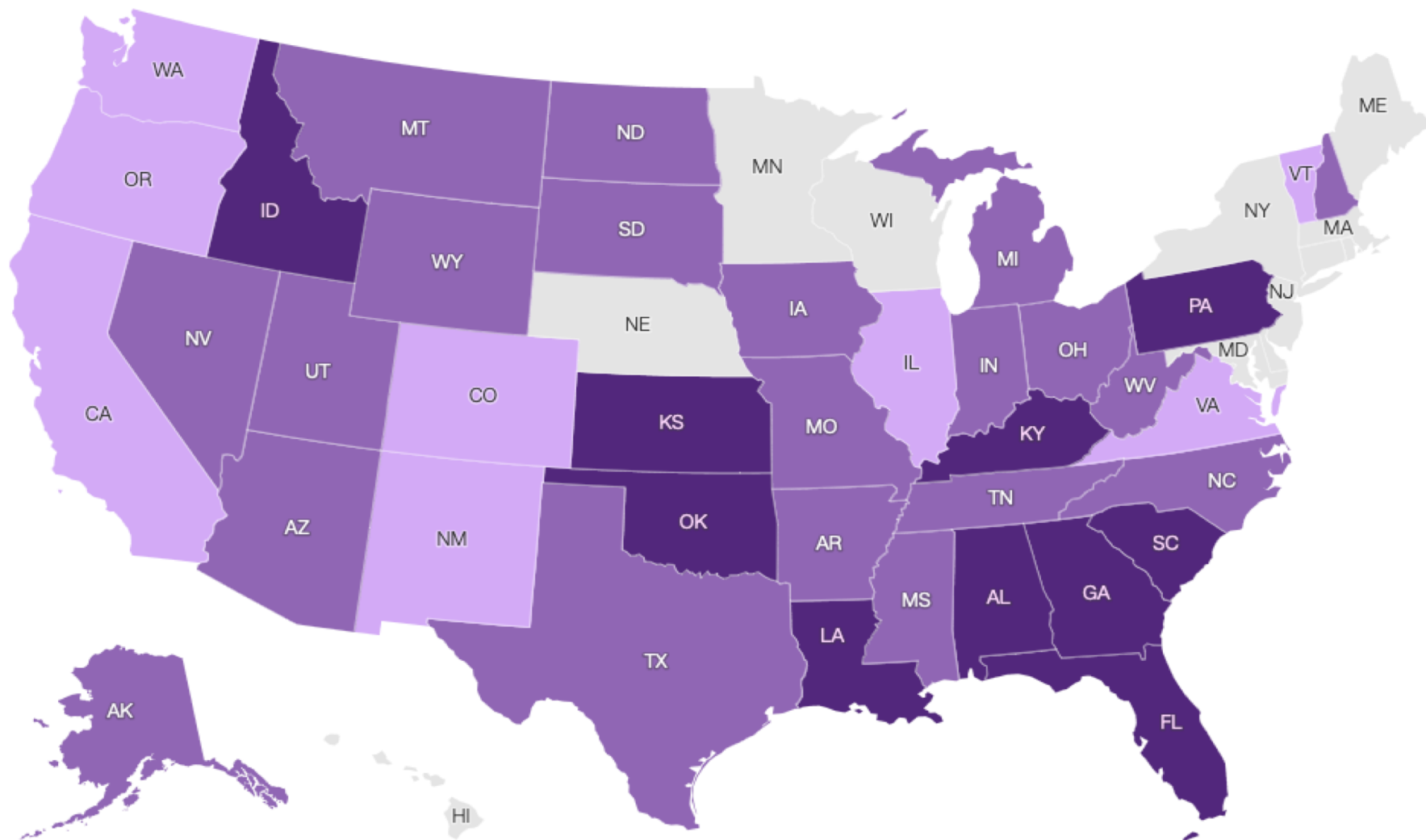
Under the law, a person can use deadly force anywhere as long as they are not engaged in an unlawful activity, is being attacked in a place they have a right to be, and reasonably believes that their life and safety are in danger as a result of an overt act or perceived threat committed by someone else.

THE CASTLE DOCTRINE

The “castle doctrine” gives a person the right to defend themselves from someone they feel is threatening them if they’re in a place where they have a right to be in

State stand-your-ground laws, by method enacted

■ By state legislature, with "stand-your-ground" language ■ By state legislature ■ By judges



Note: Data as of April 18

RED FLAG LAWS

If a gun owner poses a threat, the police — and in some states, family members — may petition a judge for an order, often called an extreme risk protection order. The subject of an order **must surrender his or her weapons** to law enforcement and is barred from purchasing firearms for a limited period of time.

Nineteen states and the District of Columbia have red flag laws

PRESIDENTIAL ASSASSINATIONS AND ASSASSINATION ATTEMPTS

1865: Abraham Lincoln (assassinated)

1963: John Fitzgerald Kennedy (assassinated)

1981 : Ronald Reagan (attempt)

2024: presidential candidate Donald Trump (2 attempts)

FACTS AND FIGURES: MORE GUNS THAN PEOPLE

There are an estimated **434 million guns** in circulation in the USA, among 50 million households, and they are held by a third of the American population.

(There are currently a little more than 335m inhabitants in the USA.)

TRAGIC EVENTS IN AMERICAN HISTORY

A mass shooting is defined as a single shooting incident which kills or injures four or more people, including the assailant.

1999: The Columbine High School shooting (Littleton, Colorado)

2012: The Sandy Hook Elementary School shooting (Newtown, Connecticut)

2017: The Las Vegas shooting, the deadliest one in the USA

2018: The Stoneman Douglas High School shooting (Parkland, Florida)

2025: The Florida State University shooting → some students had been witnesses of the 2018 Parkland shooting

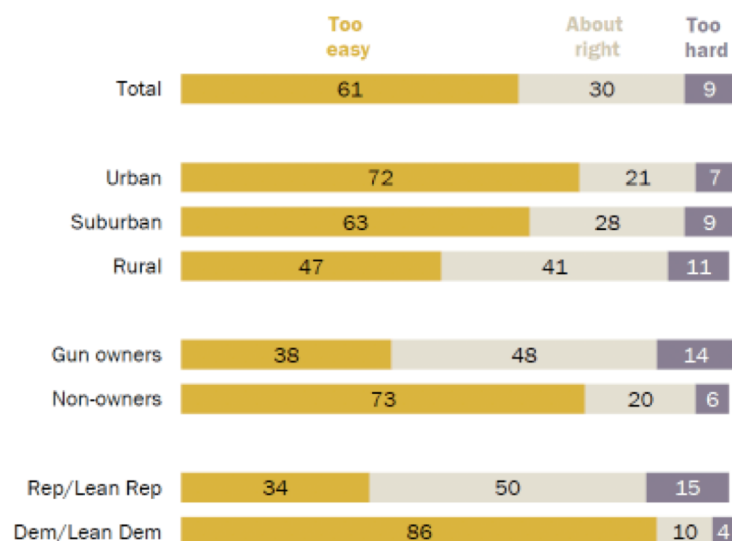
272 shootings as of August 2025

A word cloud shaped like the United States map, with city names as the words. The size of each city name corresponds to its population. Major cities like New York, Los Angeles, and Chicago are the largest. The map includes all 50 states and the District of Columbia.

PUBLIC OPINION ON GUNS

About 6 in 10 Americans say it is too easy to legally obtain a gun in this country

% who say it is ___ to legally obtain a gun in this country



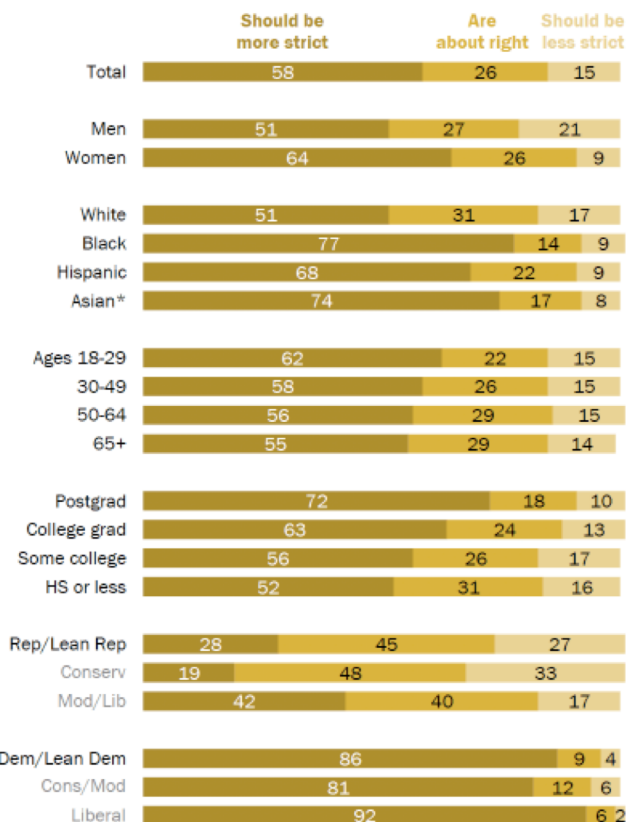
Note: No answer responses are not shown.

Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted June 5-11, 2023.

PEW RESEARCH CENTER

Women are more likely than men to favor stricter gun laws in the U.S.

% who say gun laws ...



* Estimates for Asian adults are representative of English speakers only.

Note: White, Black and Asian adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanics are of any race. No answer responses not shown.

Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted June 5-11, 2023.

PEW RESEARCH CENTER

Supreme Court strikes down Trump-era ban on rapid-fire rifle bump stocks, reopening political fight

The Supreme Court on Friday struck down a Trump-era ban on bump stocks, the rapid-fire gun accessories used in the deadliest mass shooting in modern U.S. history, in a ruling that threw firearms back into the nation's political spotlight.

The high court's conservative majority found that the Trump administration overstepped when it changed course from predecessors and banned bump stocks, which allow a rate of fire comparable to machine guns. The decision came after a gunman in Las Vegas attacked a country music festival with semiautomatic rifles equipped with the accessories.

www.apnews.com, June 15, 2024

US Supreme Court upholds federal 'ghost guns' restrictions

The U.S. Supreme Court upheld on Wednesday a regulation targeting largely untraceable "ghost guns" imposed by Democratic former President Joe Biden's administration in a crackdown on firearms whose use has proliferated in crimes nationwide, finding the measure to be consistent with a 1968 federal law.

March, 26, 2025, www.reuters.com

IT ONLY WORKS
WITH 3-D PRINTERS



BEFORE



AFTER



GUN CONTROL FOR DUMMIES